



The Ultimate SaaS Launch Checklist — 68 Things Before You Ship

68 items · 10 categories · 28 must-haves · Updated March 2026



Pro tip: Start with every ● **Must have** item first — those are the ones that will bite you on launch day. Come back for the rest in week two.



Analytics & Tracking

- ☐ Product analytics installed (PostHog, Mixpanel, or Amplitude) ● Must have
- ☐ Key activation & retention events defined — not just pageviews ● Must have
- ☐ Google Search Console verified and sitemap submitted ● Must have
- ☐ Bing Webmaster Tools set up ● Should have
- ☐ Session replay enabled for debugging UX issues ○ Nice to have
- ☐ Funnel tracking: signup → activation → conversion ● Must have



SEO & Discoverability

- ☐ XML sitemap generated and submitted ● Must have
- ☐ robots.txt configured correctly ● Must have
- ☐ OpenGraph images set for all key pages ● Must have
- ☐ Twitter / X card meta tags added ● Should have
- ☐ Structured data / JSON-LD (Organization, Product, FAQ) ● Should have
- ☐ Canonical URLs on every page ● Should have

- ☐ Meta titles & descriptions written for all pages ● Must have
 - ☐ Social previews tested (opengraph.xyz or metatags.io) ● Should have
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Branding & Assets

- ☐ Favicon set (16×16, 32×32, SVG) ● Must have
 - ☐ Apple Touch Icon (180×180) ● Should have
 - ☐ Web App Manifest for PWA support ○ Nice to have
 - ☐ Custom 404 page that's actually helpful ● Should have
 - ☐ Loading skeletons / states across the app ● Should have
 - ☐ Empty states designed so first-time users see value ● Should have
 - ☐ Images compressed & optimized (WebP / AVIF) ● Should have
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Legal & Compliance

- ☐ Privacy Policy published ● Must have
 - ☐ Terms of Service published ● Must have
 - ☐ Cookie consent banner (GDPR if serving EU users) ● Must have
 - ☐ Data Processing Agreement ready (if B2B) ● Should have
 - ☐ GDPR data export / deletion flow ● Should have
 - ☐ Acceptable Use Policy (if user-generated content) ○ Nice to have
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Security

- ☐ HTTPS everywhere — force redirect from HTTP ● Must have
- ☐ Security headers (CSP, HSTS, X-Frame-Options) ● Must have
- ☐ Input validation & sanitization ● Must have
- ☐ Rate limiting on API & auth endpoints ● Must have
- ☐ security.txt for responsible disclosure ● Should have
- ☐ Secrets out of codebase → env vars or vault ● Must have

- ☐ Dependency vulnerability scanning (Snyk, npm audit) ● Should have
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Email & Communications

- ☐ Support email set up (support@ or help@) with proper routing ● Must have
 - ☐ Transactional email provider (Resend, Postmark, SES) ● Must have
 - ☐ SPF, DKIM, DMARC records configured ● Must have
 - ☐ Welcome email sent on signup ● Should have
 - ☐ Password reset flow tested end to end ● Must have
 - ☐ Email templates tested across clients ○ Nice to have
 - ☐ Unsubscribe link in marketing emails (CAN-SPAM) ● Must have
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Monitoring & Reliability

- ☐ Error tracking live (Sentry, Bugsnag) ● Must have
 - ☐ Uptime monitoring (BetterStack, UptimeRobot) ● Must have
 - ☐ Structured logging in production ● Should have
 - ☐ Public status page ● Should have
 - ☐ Alerting wired up (Slack, email, PagerDuty) ● Should have
 - ☐ Database backup strategy — automated + tested restore ● Must have
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Billing & Payments

- ☐ Payment provider integrated (Stripe, LemonSqueezy, Paddle) ● Must have
- ☐ Upgrade / downgrade flows tested ● Must have
- ☐ Failed payment & dunning handling ● Must have
- ☐ Cancellation flow with optional feedback ● Should have
- ☐ Invoice generation & receipts ● Should have
- ☐ Free trial edge cases tested ● Should have
- ☐ Tax handling (Stripe Tax, or Paddle auto-handles) ● Should have

Performance

- ☐ Lighthouse score > 90 on core pages  Should have
 - ☐ Core Web Vitals passing (LCP, CLS, INP)  Should have
 - ☐ CDN for static assets  Should have
 - ☐ Lazy loading for images & heavy components  Nice to have
 - ☐ Gzip / Brotli compression enabled  Should have
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Launch Day

- ☐ Changelog or What's New page  Should have
 - ☐ Feedback widget or form (Canny, Featurebase, plain form)  Should have
 - ☐ Documentation / Help Center — even a minimal one  Should have
 - ☐ Onboarding flow tested with a real person  Must have
 - ☐ Production environment smoke-tested end to end  Must have
 - ☐ Social sharing copy & visuals prepared  Should have
 - ☐ Launch post ready (Product Hunt, HN, Reddit, X)  Nice to have
 - ☐ Rollback plan if something goes wrong  Must have
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 **You made it!** If every  item is checked, you're launch-ready. Ship it.

Found this useful? Share it with a friend who's about to launch their SaaS.